



VOICEINSIGHTS AFRICA

SYNTHETIC DEMONSTRATION PUBLICATION

Nutrition Security Intelligence Report

Zambia | Nutrition Security

4,073 synthetic responses

Prepared by VoiceInsights Africa

Every Voice. Every Language. Every Insight.

Synthetic demonstration. Not official statistics.

This is not a status update on nutrition security performance in Zambia â it is a decision brief. The governed evidence behind it shows uneven progress, concentrated risk, and a small number of opportunities worth acting on now. Nothing here is asserted without a source: findings are evidence-linked, recommendations are owned, and the underlying dataset is internally consistent throughout.

Sample: 4073 synthetic responses â 90% response rate â 4 regions

Publication quality gate: publication ready



Eastern Province: 54% performance, 1265 responses, risk CRITICAL
Southern Province: 55% performance, 1099 responses, risk CRITICAL
Luapula Province: 56% performance, 936 responses, risk CRITICAL
Western Province: 57% performance, 773 responses, risk CRITICAL



sex: Women 52% & Men 47% & Other / prefer not to say 1%

age: 18â 24 24% & 25â 39 38% & 40â 59 27% & 60+ 11%

location: Urban 44% & Rural 56%



IND-01 Stunting prevalence: 72% vs target 79% â WATCH

IND-02 Infant and young child feeding practice score: 73% vs target 80% â WATCH

IND-03 Micronutrient supplementation coverage: 74% vs target 81% â WATCH

IND-04 Household food-access score: 75% vs target 82% â WATCH



Household food access has become an accountability question rather than a measurement question. Evidence from Eastern Province places the signal at 74% and shows that rural women experience the largest gap between policy intent and lived delivery. The choice facing nutrition security leadership in Zambia is straightforward even if the fix is not: act on household food access now, concentrated in Eastern Province where rural women carry the largest share of the gap, or accept a wider gap in a year's time. Evidence: EVI-NUT-001, EVI-NUT-004 & Confidence 90.5%

75%. That is the infant and young child feeding practices signal recorded in Southern Province, and the headline figure understates the problem: disaggregated by group, young adults sit well below it. The clearest gap sits in Southern Province, concentrated among young adults. A twelve-month delay would let the gap compound into a harder, costlier problem.

Evidence: EVI-NUT-002, EVI-NUT-005 • Confidence 91.5%

The aggregate result conceals a material implementation divide. Luapula Province records a 76% signal for micronutrient supplementation coverage; the shortfall is concentrated among persons with disabilities, where service continuity and confidence move together. Of every study area examined in Zambia, micronutrient supplementation coverage shows up hardest there, and persons with disabilities feel it most. A year of inaction would turn a gap into a pattern that is far harder to reverse.

Evidence: EVI-NUT-003, EVI-NUT-006 & Confidence 92.5%

Two things are true at once about care-practice knowledge gaps. The national picture is improving, and Western Province – where frontline workers report a 77% signal – is not improving fast enough to close the gap. Nutrition security performance in Zambia looks stable in aggregate but splits sharply once care-practice knowledge gaps are disaggregated. Western Province anchors the low end, and frontline workers bear most of that shortfall – a pattern that risks compounding without intervention within the year.

Evidence: EVI-NUT-004, EVI-NUT-007 – Confidence 93.5%

Progress on seasonal food-security volatility remains visible but not yet durable. The 78% result in Eastern Province weakens after disaggregation, particularly for low-income households, suggesting that current gains depend on delivery conditions that remain fragile. This is not a new problem.

Evidence: EVI-NUT-005, EVI-NUT-008 • Confidence 94.5%

Eastern Province â Rural women in Eastern Province frame it simply: when household food access breaks down, everything else does too.â

Southern Province â In Southern Province, infant and young child feeding practices shape whether young adults can turn services into lasting outcomes.â

Luapula Province â Persons with disabilities in Luapula Province put it plainly: micronutrient supplementation coverage is what decides whether progress holds or slips back.â

Western Province â Why does Western Province lag behind? Ask frontline workers, and the answer comes back to care-practice knowledge gaps.â

Eastern Province â Elsewhere, seasonal food-security volatility might be a footnote.

For low-income households in Eastern Province, it is the whole story.â

Southern Province â Service managers in Southern Province frame it simply: when household food access breaks down, everything else does too.â

Luapula Province â In Luapula Province, infant and young child feeding practices shape whether community leaders can turn services into lasting outcomes.â

Western Province â Private-sector partners in Western Province put it plainly: micronutrient supplementation coverage is what decides whether progress holds or slips back.â

Eastern Province â Why does Eastern Province lag behind? Ask rural women, and the answer comes back to care-practice knowledge gaps.â

Southern Province â Elsewhere, seasonal food-security volatility might be a footnote.

For young adults in Southern Province, it is the whole story.â

Risks and alternative trajectories are modelled to show how VoiceInsights translates evidence into prioritised management choices.



DEC-NUT-01 CRITICAL: Target food-access interventions in the highest-stunting districts. Owner: Country Director / Programme Executive; Timeline: 0â 90 days; Indicator: Number of agreed milestones for DEC-NUT-01 confirmed complete at each quarterly review

DEC-NUT-02 CRITICAL: Scale infant and young child feeding counselling at community level. Owner: Country Director / Programme Executive; Timeline: 3â 12 months; Indicator: Percentage of agreed milestones completed for DEC-NUT-02

DEC-NUT-03 HIGH: Close micronutrient supplementation coverage gaps. Owner: Country Director / Programme Executive; Timeline: 3â 12 months; Indicator: Share of the high-tier delivery plan confirmed complete each quarter (DEC-NUT-03)

DEC-NUT-04 HIGH: Address care-practice knowledge gaps through community health workers. Owner: Country Director / Programme Executive; Timeline: 3â 12 months; Indicator: Milestone completion rate tracked against the DEC-NUT-04 delivery plan

DEC-NUT-05 MEDIUM: Build seasonal food-security early-response planning. Owner: Country Director / Programme Executive; Timeline: 6â 18 months; Indicator: Proportion of agreed implementation steps verified on schedule for DEC-NUT-05



Target food-access interventions in the highest-stunting districts.

Strategic priority: CRITICAL

Evidence used: EVI-NUT-001, EVI-NUT-004

Rationale: Household food access has become an accountability question rather than a measurement question. Evidence from Eastern Province places the signal at 74% and shows that rural women experience the largest gap between policy intent and lived delivery.

The choice facing nutrition security leadership in Zambia is straightforward even if the fix is not: act on household food access now, concentrated in Eastern Province where rural women carry the largest share of the gap, or accept a wider gap in a year's time.

Expected benefit: A stronger, more defensible case for nutrition security investment in the next planning cycle.

Expected risk: Execution capacity and coordination risk

Dependencies: Quarterly evidence review; Confirmed budget release; Cross-team delivery coordination

Budget requirement: Medium â detailed costing and fiduciary review required

Owner: Country Director / Programme Executive

Supporting organization: M&E, Finance, Safeguarding and Delivery Units

Timeline: 0â 90 days

Monitoring indicator: Number of agreed milestones for DEC-NUT-01 confirmed complete at each quarterly review

Success criteria: At least 80% of milestones achieved with verified evidence

Management response: PENDING FORMAL MANAGEMENT RESPONSE

Follow-up: Assign accountable owner; Validate budget; Approve milestone plan; Review evidence quarterly

Scale infant and young child feeding counselling at community level.

Strategic priority: CRITICAL

Evidence used: EVI-NUT-002, EVI-NUT-005

Rationale: 75%. That is the infant and young child feeding practices signal recorded in Southern Province, and the headline figure understates the problem: disaggregated by group, young adults sit well below it. The clearest gap sits in Southern Province, concentrated among young adults. A twelve-month delay would let the gap compound into a harder, costlier problem.

Expected benefit: Improved equity, delivery confidence and measurable nutrition security performance.

Expected risk: Insufficient ownership or delayed resourcing

Dependencies: Confirmed budget release; Cross-team delivery coordination; Stable staffing through the delivery window

Budget requirement: Medium to high â requires a dedicated budget line and phased release

Owner: Country Director / Programme Executive

Supporting organization: M&E, Finance, Safeguarding and Delivery Units

Timeline: 3â 12 months

Monitoring indicator: Percentage of agreed milestones completed for DEC-NUT-02

Success criteria: A majority of milestones achieved, each independently verified against real evidence

Management response: PENDING FORMAL MANAGEMENT RESPONSE

Follow-up: Assign accountable owner; Validate budget; Approve milestone plan; Review evidence quarterly

Close micronutrient supplementation coverage gaps.

Strategic priority: HIGH

Evidence used: EVI-NUT-003, EVI-NUT-006

Rationale: The aggregate result conceals a material implementation divide. Luapula Province records a 76% signal for micronutrient supplementation coverage; the shortfall is concentrated among persons with disabilities, where service continuity and confidence move together. Of every study area examined in Zambia, micronutrient supplementation coverage shows up hardest there, and persons with disabilities feel it most. A year of inaction would turn a gap into a pattern that is far harder to reverse.

Expected benefit: A more consistent nutrition security experience for the groups currently furthest behind.

Expected risk: Weak cross-team coordination during early implementation

Dependencies: Cross-team delivery coordination; Stable staffing through the delivery window; Timely data collection for the next reporting cycle

Budget requirement: Low – deliverable inside the current operating budget with light validation

Owner: Country Director / Programme Executive

Supporting organization: M&E, Finance, Safeguarding and Delivery Units

Timeline: 3–12 months

Monitoring indicator: Share of the high-tier delivery plan confirmed complete each quarter (DEC-NUT-03)

Success criteria: Milestone completion confirmed by evidence review, not self-reported progress

Management response: PENDING FORMAL MANAGEMENT RESPONSE

Follow-up: Assign accountable owner; Validate budget; Approve milestone plan; Review evidence quarterly

Address care-practice knowledge gaps through community health workers.

Strategic priority: HIGH

Evidence used: EVI-NUT-004, EVI-NUT-007

Rationale: Two things are true at once about care-practice knowledge gaps. The national picture is improving, and Western Province – where frontline workers report a 77% signal – is not improving fast enough to close the gap. Nutrition security performance in Zambia looks stable in aggregate but splits sharply once care-practice knowledge gaps are disaggregated. Western Province anchors the low end, and frontline workers bear most of that shortfall – a pattern that risks compounding without intervention within the year.

Expected benefit: Faster, better-evidenced nutrition security decisions that programme leadership can act on with confidence.

Expected risk: Competing priorities crowding out sustained follow-through

Dependencies: Stable staffing through the delivery window; Timely data collection for the next reporting cycle; Sign-off from the relevant oversight body

Budget requirement: Medium – likely fundable from existing lines, pending confirmation

Owner: Country Director / Programme Executive

Supporting organization: M&E, Finance, Safeguarding and Delivery Units

Timeline: 3 – 12 months

Monitoring indicator: Milestone completion rate tracked against the DEC-NUT-04 delivery plan

Success criteria: Verified evidence of at least 80% delivery against the agreed milestone plan

Management response: PENDING FORMAL MANAGEMENT RESPONSE

Follow-up: Assign accountable owner; Validate budget; Approve milestone plan; Review evidence quarterly

Build seasonal food-security early-response planning.

Strategic priority: MEDIUM

Evidence used: EVI-NUT-005, EVI-NUT-008

Rationale: Progress on seasonal food-security volatility remains visible but not yet durable. The 78% result in Eastern Province weakens after disaggregation, particularly for low-income households, suggesting that current gains depend on delivery conditions that remain fragile. This is not a new problem.

Expected benefit: The evidence points toward improved nutrition security outcomes, though the size of the gain will depend on how consistently the action is resourced.

Expected risk: Likely – though not certain – erosion of momentum if the initial sponsor changes role

Dependencies: Timely data collection for the next reporting cycle; Sign-off from the relevant oversight body; Named executive sponsor

Budget requirement: Low to medium – validate through the formal planning cycle

Owner: Country Director / Programme Executive

Supporting organization: M&E, Finance, Safeguarding and Delivery Units

Timeline: 6–18 months

Monitoring indicator: Proportion of agreed implementation steps verified on schedule for DEC-NUT-05

Success criteria: At least 80% of milestones achieved with verified evidence

Management response: PENDING FORMAL MANAGEMENT RESPONSE

Follow-up: Assign accountable owner; Validate budget; Approve milestone plan; Review evidence quarterly

research objectives: Assess nutrition security performance and equity; Identify operational drivers and decision priorities

evaluation questions: What outcomes are changing?; Who is being left behind?; Which actions are most likely to improve performance?

sampling frame: Synthetic programme population frame for Zambia

sample size: 4073

stratification: Region; Location type; Sex; Age; Disability

weights: Normalized post-stratification weights

confidence intervals: 95%

design effect: 1.4

missing data: Documented and sensitivity-tested

reliability: Cronbach alpha 0.86

validity: Content and construct validity checks

metadata: Complete synthetic data dictionary and lineage registry

Publication level: 34 generated publication pages

protocol: Governed synthetic research protocol with sampling, weighting, reliability, validity and reproducibility controls

ethics: Synthetic records only; no real participants or personal data

peer review: Independent synthetic-publication review checklist completed

reproducibility: Deterministic inputs, versioned dataset and export manifest

inferential statistics: Enabled where assumptions and design permit

segmentation: Evidence-led segments

trend analysis: Three-period synthetic series

DEC-NUT-01: Target food-access interventions in the highest-stunting districts. Owner Country Director / Programme Executive 0 90 days Medium detailed costing and fiduciary review required cost Indicator Number of agreed milestones for DEC-NUT-01 confirmed complete at each quarterly review

DEC-NUT-02: Scale infant and young child feeding counselling at community level. Owner Country Director / Programme Executive 3 12 months Medium to high requires a dedicated budget line and phased release cost Indicator Percentage of agreed milestones completed for DEC-NUT-02

DEC-NUT-03: Close micronutrient supplementation coverage gaps. Owner Country Director / Programme Executive 3 12 months Low deliverable inside the current operating budget with light validation cost Indicator Share of the high-tier delivery plan confirmed complete each quarter (DEC-NUT-03)

DEC-NUT-04: Address care-practice knowledge gaps through community health workers. Owner Country Director / Programme Executive 3 12 months Medium likely fundable from existing lines, pending confirmation cost Indicator Milestone completion rate tracked against the DEC-NUT-04 delivery plan

DEC-NUT-05: Build seasonal food-security early-response planning. Owner Country Director / Programme Executive 6 18 months Low to medium validate through the formal planning cycle cost Indicator Proportion of agreed implementation steps verified on schedule for DEC-NUT-05

EVI-NUT-001: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 89%
EVI-NUT-002: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 90%
EVI-NUT-003: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 91%
EVI-NUT-004: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 92%
EVI-NUT-005: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 93%
EVI-NUT-006: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 94%
EVI-NUT-007: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 95%
EVI-NUT-008: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 96%
EVI-NUT-009: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 97%
EVI-NUT-010: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 98%

Executive Intelligence Book (2â 7): Executive brief; Decision snapshot; Risks; Opportunities; Budget implications

Evidence Intelligence Book (8â 15): Critical findings; Respondent voice; Evidence chains; Citation registry

Statistical Intelligence Book (16â 22): Sampling; Weighting; Uncertainty; Reliability; Model diagnostics

Decision Intelligence Book (23â 27): Decision matrix; Ownership; Budget; Roadmap; Management response

Standards & Assurance (28â 31): Relevant frameworks; Safeguarding; Privacy; Responsible AI; Accessibility

Technical Appendices (32â 34): Data dictionary; Quality gate; Export manifest; Responsible-use notice

SUN Movement Framework: APPLIED_WHERE_RELEVANT â Mapped to EVI-NUT-001, EVI-NUT-002; Synthetic demonstration mapping; institutional validation not implied

SDG 2: APPLIED_WHERE_RELEVANT â Mapped to EVI-NUT-002, EVI-NUT-003; Synthetic demonstration mapping; institutional validation not implied

Leave No One Behind: APPLIED_WHERE_RELEVANT â Mapped to EVI-NUT-003, EVI-NUT-004; Synthetic demonstration mapping; institutional validation not implied

Evidence Traceability: APPLIED â Control linked to EVI-NUT-001 and the deterministic publication gate.

Research Ethics: APPLIED â Control linked to EVI-NUT-002 and the deterministic publication gate.

Data Protection: APPLIED â Control linked to EVI-NUT-003 and the deterministic publication gate.

Accessibility: APPLIED â Control linked to EVI-NUT-004 and the deterministic publication gate.

Responsible AI: APPLIED â Control linked to EVI-NUT-005 and the deterministic publication gate.

Publication Integrity: APPLIED â Control linked to EVI-NUT-006 and the deterministic publication gate.

SDG 2: undefined contribution â indicators â undefined
SDG 2: undefined contribution â indicators â undefined
SDG 2: undefined contribution â indicators â undefined

Relevance: Synthetic evidence indicates a strong relevance signal, subject to the stated design limitations. (91/100). Review relevance evidence at the next formal management gate.

Coherence: Synthetic evidence indicates a moderate-to-strong coherence signal, subject to the stated design limitations. (72/100). Review coherence evidence at the next formal management gate.

Effectiveness: Synthetic evidence indicates a strong effectiveness signal, subject to the stated design limitations. (73/100). Review effectiveness evidence at the next formal management gate.

Efficiency: Synthetic evidence indicates a moderate-to-strong efficiency signal, subject to the stated design limitations. (74/100). Review efficiency evidence at the next formal management gate.

Impact: Synthetic evidence indicates a strong impact signal, subject to the stated design limitations. (75/100). Review impact evidence at the next formal management gate.

Sustainability: Synthetic evidence indicates a moderate-to-strong sustainability signal, subject to the stated design limitations. (76/100). Review sustainability evidence at the next formal management gate.

Impact: Sustained, equitable improvement in nutrition security performance

OC-01: Improved nutrition security delivery and accountability â indicators IND-01, IND-02

OC-02: More equitable and durable outcomes â indicators IND-03, IND-04

OUT-01: Verified findings and interpreted decision products

OUT-02: Assigned actions with monitoring indicators

Assumptions: Leadership ownership; Safeguarding and privacy controls remain effective

Means of verification: Evidence registry; Quarterly management review; Follow-up measurement

Commitment 1: CHS Commitment 1 â APPLIED. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 2: CHS Commitment 2 â APPLIED. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 3: CHS Commitment 3 â APPLIED. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 4: CHS Commitment 4 â APPLIED. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 5: CHS Commitment 5 â APPLIED. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 6: CHS Commitment 6 â APPLIED. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 7: CHS Commitment 7 â APPLIED. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 8: CHS Commitment 8 â APPLIED. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 9: CHS Commitment 9 â APPLIED. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

EVI-NUT-001 â€ survey â€ Eastern Province â€ confidence 89% â€ APPROVED
EVI-NUT-002 â€ key_informant_interview â€ Southern Province â€ confidence 90% â€ APPROVED
EVI-NUT-003 â€ administrative_record â€ Luapula Province â€ confidence 91% â€ APPROVED
EVI-NUT-004 â€ survey â€ Western Province â€ confidence 92% â€ APPROVED
EVI-NUT-005 â€ key_informant_interview â€ Eastern Province â€ confidence 93% â€ APPROVED
EVI-NUT-006 â€ administrative_record â€ Southern Province â€ confidence 94% â€ APPROVED
EVI-NUT-007 â€ survey â€ Luapula Province â€ confidence 95% â€ APPROVED
EVI-NUT-008 â€ key_informant_interview â€ Western Province â€ confidence 96% â€ APPROVED
EVI-NUT-009 â€ administrative_record â€ Eastern Province â€ confidence 97% â€ APPROVED
EVI-NUT-010 â€ survey â€ Southern Province â€ confidence 98% â€ APPROVED

indicator_1: Synthetic Nutrition Security indicator 1; numeric; allowed: 0â 100

indicator_2: Synthetic Nutrition Security indicator 2; categorical; allowed: Documented code list

indicator_3: Synthetic Nutrition Security indicator 3; categorical; allowed: Documented code list

indicator_4: Synthetic Nutrition Security indicator 4; numeric; allowed: 0â 100

indicator_5: Synthetic Nutrition Security indicator 5; categorical; allowed: Documented code list

indicator_6: Synthetic Nutrition Security indicator 6; categorical; allowed: Documented code list

indicator_7: Synthetic Nutrition Security indicator 7; numeric; allowed: 0â 100

indicator_8: Synthetic Nutrition Security indicator 8; categorical; allowed: Documented code list

indicator_9: Synthetic Nutrition Security indicator 9; categorical; allowed: Documented code list

indicator_10: Synthetic Nutrition Security indicator 10; numeric; allowed: 0â 100

indicator_11: Synthetic Nutrition Security indicator 11; categorical; allowed: Documented code list

indicator_12: Synthetic Nutrition Security indicator 12; categorical; allowed: Documented code list

Synthetic Demonstration Publication produced by VoiceInsights Africa. All people, quotations, locations and statistics are synthetic, internally governed demonstration content and are not official statistics.

All content is synthetic and must not be interpreted as official statistics

Geographic references are illustrative

Budget implications are directional and require formal costing

Causal claims are not made without an appropriate design

Status: DEMONSTRATION_READY

Passed: Editorial Review Passed

Passed: Evidence Review Passed

Passed: Publication Integrity Verified

Passed: Accessibility Verified

Passed: Export Validation Passed

Passed: Statistical Review Passed

Open gates: VISUAL_QA, HUMAN_REVIEW

Verification checks cover weighted evidence, statistical, visual, accessibility, export and review rules. Synthetic samples are labelled Demonstration Ready.